

Dan Welch

Senior Software Engineer · Design Systems

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Hampden, ME | Remote

SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 17+ years building design systems and the tooling that drives their adoption. Primary architect of enterprise design systems at Bankrate and Launch That: React/Next.js component platforms, design token pipelines, and internal tools adopted across product and design teams. Strong in TypeScript, React, Node.js, advanced CSS, Storybook, and AI-assisted engineering workflows.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **Built internal tools that accelerate design and engineering workflows:** Bankrate's design systems and Vue.js apps (ReportaRoo, DisavOwl).
- **Used AI to build, not just consume it:** co-led an internal hackathon prototyping the migration of legacy JavaScript calculators to React with AI coding agents.
- **Made engineering decisions from data:** audited Storyblok component usage, built a tracking dashboard, and used it to decide what to eliminate or migrate (289 components, ~30%).
- **Owned adoption end to end:** launched Treasury across a dozen-plus projects with zero production incidents and drove company-wide education and mentoring.

EXPERIENCE

Bankrate (a Red Ventures company)

09/2021—06/2026

Senior Software Engineer | Design Systems Architect

Remote

- **Architected and led the implementation of The Ledger**, Bankrate's React/Next.js design system, creating a scalable component platform adopted across product teams. Built 65+ reusable components with TypeScript and Tailwind, supporting white-label theming through a token-based architecture.
- **Built the operational foundation for Ledger**, including automated testing, accessibility validation, CI workflows, token compilation, Storybook documentation, and versioned releases to support reliable adoption across engineering teams.
- **Architected and led the implementation of The Treasury**, Bankrate's first formal design system. Launched Jan 2025 and adopted across a dozen-plus projects with zero production incidents, replacing a legacy CSS framework. Later succeeded by The Ledger following a leadership-directed shift to React/Next.js-native delivery.
- **Led a data-driven Storyblok component audit:** built a dashboard to track usage, then used that data to decide what to eliminate or migrate, cutting 289 components (~30%) and simplifying content workflows.
- **Authored Playwright E2E suites** integrated into GitHub Actions. Cut CI execution time by ~76% and caught pre-release regressions before they entered production.
- **Served on Bankrate's A11y and Performance task forces**, resolving WCAG compliance issues and running performance audits with Lighthouse CI and Chrome UX Report (CrUX) across product teams, and acting as an internal consultant on Core Web Vitals best practices and front-end performance optimization.
- **Authored and championed AI-assisted development practices across the team:** custom prompt rules and configurations for Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, and Codex, covering component generation, documentation, and code review, shared in bi-weekly team sessions.
- **Drove design system education and adoption company-wide**, facilitating lunch-and-learns for cross-functional groups of engineers, designers, and product managers. One-on-one mentoring with developers on component architecture, advanced CSS, Tailwind optimization, and design system standards.

Bankrate (a Red Ventures company)

03/2025 – 09/2025

Engineering Manager | Interim

Remote

- **Managed a team of 7 (4 FTEs + 3 contractors) over 6 months**, driving a ~10% increase in sprint velocity through process improvements and conducting mid-cycle performance reviews.
- **Co-led an internal AI hackathon** to prototype migrating legacy JavaScript calculators to React, an approach the team adopted for the full migration.

EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Launch That

Senior Front-End Developer

09/2016—09/2021
Orlando, FL

- **Architected the Ares Framework**, a custom component library and WordPress parent theme powering all Launch That properties, establishing the shared design system foundation that now defines my career. Leveraged it to ship 6 multi-page WordPress sites in a single month.
- **Trained directly with Brad Frost** (creator of the Atomic Design methodology, which focuses on modular interface design) in a hands-on two-day design system workshop, laying the groundwork for the approaches used in Ares and later at Bankrate.
- **Built ReportaRoo and DisavOwl**, two internal productivity tools built in Vue.js that automated marketing reporting and streamlined the SEO link-disavow process, replacing workflows previously done manually by analysts.

Studio Birdsall

Lead Front-End / Senior Web Developer

08/2014—09/2016
Winter Park, FL

- **Led front-end development across 10+ client projects**, including Magento and Shopify e-commerce builds and custom WordPress sites, delivering production-ready websites on schedule.

Full Sail University

Senior Web Developer

10/2008—08/2014
Winter Park, FL

- **Led front-end development for Full Sail University**, including the main marketing sites, blog, hundreds of landing pages & email campaigns, and the interfaces for the university's first online store and online school. Advanced from Web Developer to Senior within three years.

SKILLS

Languages:

TypeScript, JavaScript, Semantic HTML, Modern CSS, PHP

Frameworks & Libraries:

React, Next.js, Vue.js (Vuex, Pinia), Astro, Node.js, Tailwind CSS, Laravel

Design Systems:

Component Architecture, Storybook, Design Tokens (DTCG), ShadCN Registry, Multi-Brand Theming / White-Labeling, Branding

Practices:

Accessibility (WCAG / A11y), Core Web Vitals (Lighthouse CI, CrUX), Progressive Enhancement, Responsive Design, Typography, Information Architecture, Figma Collaboration, Design-to-Code Handoff, REST API Integration, UI/UX Consulting, Technical Writing

CMS & Platforms:

Storyblok (Headless CMS), WordPress (Blade or Twig templating, ACF, Gutenberg), Shopify

Testing & CI/CD:

Playwright (E2E), Vitest, Jest, axe-core, Biome, GitHub Actions, Semantic Release (semver / conventional commits)

AI & Modern Workflow:

Cursor, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, OpenAI Codex, MCP tooling; daily use across code generation, refactoring, documentation, rapid prototyping, and design-system development; custom rules & prompt authoring

Leadership:

Engineering Management, Team Mentorship, Stakeholder Alignment, Project Scoping & Roadmapping

EDUCATION

Full Sail University

B.S. Digital Arts & Design

09/2006—08/2008
Winter Park, FL

Valedictorian

University of Maine

Digital Media

09/2005—05/2006
Orono, ME